

INCOME DISTRIBUTION OF EARNING INDIAN YOUTH

• India has multiple consumer groups, which means companies need to remain flexible

Income	2024-25 Million	%	Share of Rural %
• Low (Less than ₹60,000)	12	7.5	89
• Lower Middle (₹60,001-₹1.2 lakh)	43	26.7	74
• Middle (₹1.2 lakh-3 lakh)	57	35.1	48
• Upper Middle (₹3-6 lakh)	33	20.6	30
• High (More than ₹6 lakh)	16	10.1	22
Total	161	100	52

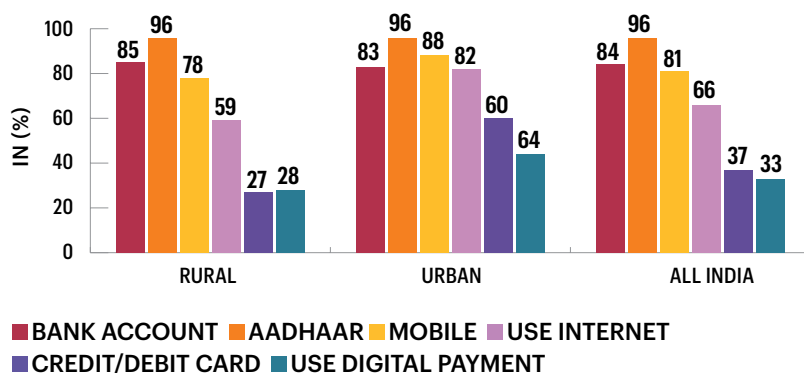
NOTE ANNUAL INCOME AT 2024-25 PRICES;

SOURCE PRICE ICE 360° RESEARCH PAPER, AUGUST 2025

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PROFILING GEN Z

• Huge opportunity in credit/debit cards and digital payments due to under-penetration



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as the single most important purchase driver. “Price and value for money matter most at lower income levels but steadily decline in importance as income and education rise,” the

survey found.

It’s not for nothing that marketers spend a lot of time understanding Gen Z. “The sheer size makes it attractive. Plus they drive premiumisation,”

says Nitin Saini, VP (Marketing), Mondelez India. Its Cadbury Silk Desserts range is one example. Biscoff cookies, he explains, were more unique and helped Mondelez expand the premium portfolio.

INDIA’S COMPLEXITY

Multiple consumer groups in the fastest-growing economy globally mean there is a need to remain flexible. Product life cycles have shortened. The rapid rise of direct-to-consumer (D2C) brands shows how much the market has changed. D2C brands can launch, test, and adapt products faster than traditional players through bypassing intermediaries, using digital channels, and relying on real-time consumer data.

And therein lies the complexity. Goupal thinks Gen Z challenges traditional marketing by demanding personalisation, digital-first experiences and, of course, authenticity. In his view, the ability to amplify narratives online makes them a powerful force.

The rise of social media as a primary discovery and engagement platform, the shift towards influencer-driven content and a growing emphasis on sustainability and inclusivity are making brands rethink how they connect with consumers.

The BT-PRICE study found social media plays a decisive but selective role in shaping Gen Z consumption. “As many as 22% purchase frequently after seeing products on social media, and a larger share (38%) do so occasionally, indicating social platforms function more as consideration-stage nudges than direct sales triggers,” it states.

Social media accounts for as much as 41% of primary internet use, especially among those in the lower-income bracket and in Tier